

# Ideal Customer Profile

*A framework for prospecting and qualification*

Prepared for the UK & I New Business team

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## THE THESIS

Device42 fits one buyer above all: **an organisation whose IT estate has outgrown the team's ability to know what it owns** — typically a complex, hybrid environment spanning on-premises, data-centre, and cloud, where a migration, audit, consolidation, or acquisition has made the cost of not knowing acute. The product's value is certainty: an automatically discovered, continuously accurate map of every asset and its dependencies. Where that certainty is mission-critical, the case is compelling. Where a spreadsheet still suffices, demand is soft.

Unlike a downtime-driven tool, Device42 is most often bought against a *project or an event*: a cloud migration to de-risk, a software audit to survive, an M&A estate to merge, a data-centre to consolidate. The parameters below are ordered by how strongly each predicts fit, and resolve into two questions: *whom to pursue* in prospecting, and *how to confirm* a genuine opportunity in qualification.

## I. How to use this framework

**Step one — Prospecting.** Build pipeline against the signals observable from the outside: the complexity and shape of the estate, organisation size, the presence of a known buying event, the maturity of asset records, and the incumbent tooling. Most can be inferred before a conversation, often from a migration announcement, an audit notice, or an acquisition.

**Step two — Qualification.** In conversation, confirm what only dialogue reveals. Treat the four Tier 1 criteria as a gate; then score the fit and winnability parameters on the matrix in Section III.

## II. The parameters

**TIER 1** Non-negotiable — disqualify if absent

**A complex, sizeable IT estate.** Hundreds to many thousands of assets spanning on-premises, virtual, cloud, and network infrastructure. The value of automated discovery rises with the sprawl it untangles; a small, simple, single-cloud estate rarely justifies the platform.

**A live driver or event.** A migration, software or hardware audit, data-centre consolidation, M&A integration, or compliance mandate that makes accurate asset and dependency data urgent. Absent a driver, the purchase tends to stall as a “nice to have.”

**Owned by IT infrastructure or asset management.** An IT Operations, Infrastructure, ITAM, or Enterprise Architecture function responsible for the estate. Where no team owns asset accuracy, there is no buyer for it.

**Current records are inadequate.** Reliance on spreadsheets, stale CMDB entries, or tribal knowledge, with acknowledged gaps. An organisation confident it already has complete, trusted asset data feels no pain.

#### **TIER 2** Strong fit signals — the basis of the fit score

**Hybrid and legacy heterogeneity.** A genuinely mixed environment — mainframe and Solaris through to containers and multi-cloud. Breadth of supported technology is a core Device42 strength and least well served by lighter inventory tools.

**Migration or cloud programme in flight.** An active or imminent data-centre exit or cloud migration, where dependency mapping and resource-utilisation data de-risk the cutover and curb runaway cost. This is the single highest-converting use case.

**Audit, compliance, or licensing exposure.** Recurring finance, security, or vendor software audits (a Microsoft or Oracle licence review especially), where a defensible, automated inventory turns a fire-drill into a report.

**Organisation size.** Mid-market to enterprise, roughly 1,000 to 25,000 employees, with an estate large enough to be unmanageable by hand yet not so vast that a heavyweight ServiceNow Discovery programme is already entrenched.

**Incumbent ITSM or CMDB to feed.** An existing ITSM platform — Freshservice above all, but also Jira Service Management or others — whose CMDB is empty or unreliable. Device42 becomes the authoritative discovery source beneath it.

#### **TIER 3** Differentiation amplifiers — where we win against the alternatives

**Freshservice in place or in evaluation.** The tightest wedge of all. The native Freshservice and Device42 pairing delivers ITSM and ITAM in one ecosystem, a story no standalone discovery vendor can match. Lead here wherever it is true.

**Depth over breadth of discovery.** Buyers who need agentless discovery to reach deep — SNMP detail, application dependencies, on-prem and legacy systems — favour Device42 over the shallower inventory of Lansweeper-class tools.

**Wants a purpose-built alternative to ServiceNow.** Organisations seeking discovery and CMDB without the cost, complexity, and multi-year implementation of ServiceNow ITOM Discovery are natural Device42 prospects.

**A note on positioning.** *Device42 is a discovery and CMDB foundation, not a full ITSM suite or a governance layer. At the very largest estates (tens of thousands of devices) and where a customer demands a single end-to-end platform, lead with the Freshservice-plus-Device42 combination rather than Device42 alone, and be candid about where ServiceNow's breadth applies.*

### **III. The scoring matrix**

Each parameter is scored from one to three. **Tier 1 is a gate: any single score of one disqualifies the account, irrespective of the total.** Tiers 2 and 3 sum into a fit score and a winnability score respectively.

|                                                                        | 1 POOR                                      | 2 ADEQUATE                                     | 3 STRONG                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>TIER 1</b> <i>Non-negotiable gate — any score of 1 disqualifies</i> |                                             |                                                |                                                       |
| <b>Estate complexity &amp; size</b>                                    | Small, simple, single-cloud estate          | Moderate estate; some mixed infrastructure     | Hundreds-plus assets across on-prem, cloud, network   |
| <b>Live driver or event</b>                                            | No driver; purely exploratory               | General desire for better records; no deadline | Active migration, audit, M&A, or consolidation        |
| <b>Ownership</b>                                                       | No team owns asset accuracy                 | Ownership exists but informal                  | Dedicated IT Ops / ITAM / EA function owns the estate |
| <b>Current records</b>                                                 | Confident they already have complete data   | Partial CMDB; some known gaps                  | Spreadsheets / stale data with acknowledged gaps      |
| <b>TIER 2</b> <i>Fit score — sum, maximum 15</i>                       |                                             |                                                |                                                       |
| <b>Hybrid / legacy mix</b>                                             | Homogeneous, modern, single-platform        | Some heterogeneity                             | Mainframe-to-container, multi-cloud heterogeneity     |
| <b>Migration programme</b>                                             | None planned                                | Under discussion                               | Active or imminent data-centre exit / cloud move      |
| <b>Audit / licence exposure</b>                                        | No meaningful audit pressure                | Occasional audits, handled manually            | Recurring audits or a live Microsoft/Oracle review    |
| <b>Organisation size</b>                                               | Under 1,000 or very large ServiceNow estate | 1,000–25,000 with partial discovery in place   | 1,000–25,000 employees; no entrenched discovery       |
| <b>ITSM / CMDB to feed</b>                                             | No ITSM, or a fully trusted CMDB already    | ITSM present; CMDB partially populated         | Freshservice/JSM with an empty or unreliable CMDB     |
| <b>TIER 3</b> <i>Winnability score — sum, maximum 9</i>                |                                             |                                                |                                                       |
| <b>Freshservice context</b>                                            | Committed to a rival ITSM, no openness      | ITSM-agnostic                                  | Freshservice in place or under evaluation             |
| <b>Depth of discovery need</b>                                         | Light inventory suffices                    | Moderate depth required                        | Needs deep agentless / SNMP / dependency discovery    |
| <b>ServiceNow alternative</b>                                          | ServiceNow ITOM Discovery entrenched        | Neutral                                        | Wants discovery without ServiceNow cost/complexity    |

## IV. Interpreting the result

**FIT SCORE** *Tier 2, maximum 15*

**12 – 15** Strong fit. Prioritise.

**8 – 11** Workable. Develop the weaker parameters before committing resource.

**5 – 7** Marginal. Deprioritise unless a Tier 3 edge is exceptional.

**WINNABILITY SCORE** Tier 3, maximum 9

**7 – 9** A structural edge. Lead with it, the Freshservice pairing above all.

**4 – 6** Competitive. Win on discovery depth and time-to-value.

**3** Rivals are well-suited here. Expect a contest.

**In sum.** *The ideal account clears all four Tier 1 gates, scores twelve or above on fit, and seven or above on winnability. The strongest single signal is a live migration or audit at a Freshservice customer with a hybrid estate and no trusted CMDB; pursue those first. Treat accounts with no live driver as nurture, not pipeline, however large the estate.*